Mini-Game Expansion

House Rules

Modify the Core Rules

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Introduction

Welcome to the Mini-Game Expansion, a rules expansion for D&D 4E. The goals of this expansion are to introduce house rules that improve the existing game, and to add new rules that streamline and automate the game. For example, the DMG has suggestions for how to run skill challenges, as well as ideas for terrain rules in a combat encounter. This expansion standardizes those choices to help players become familiar with each routine, and to make the game faster. It consist of three rule books: House Rules, StoryTelling System, and World Builder's Guide.

The House Rules book starts by defining the core rules that the expansion uses from the published rule set. It goes on to the custom character creation guide which uses the new rules provided in this expansion for weapons and feats. It standardizes the combat setup routine as well as the post-combat looting, greatly increasing the value of skills. Even further, it provides entirely new types of combat, such as the trapped area and the chase.

The StoryTelling System book introduces a new framework for standardizing and automating the adventuring tasks which are known as the *party actions*. For each task, such as purchasing magic items or traveling cross-country, a complete set of rules is provided so that players can run the task themselves. This frees up the DM so their role becomes general oversight, and not micro-management. Additionally, there are the *weekly quests*, which are randomly generated mini-quests. They are repeatable and are also run by the players themselves - eliminating the need for the DM to create new storylines for every single game day. The routine tasks and weekly quests reinforce the fact that skills are as important as attack bonus, so just creating a power-game combat character is not enough to be successful in the course of the game.

The World Builder's Guide is designed to automate the creation of the campaign setting from the inside out. It start with a region, which sets the geography (mountains, seas, etc) and terrain (forest, swamp, etc). A region is populated with kingdoms, which are built by civilized races from the Monster Manual. Kingdoms have a technology level, religion, factions, and settlements. Settlements provide the different services and businesses that form the backdrop of the party action system. Additionally, there is an encounter group generator application on the website which is the best in the world.

CHAPTER ONE

RULE SETS

RULE SETS

THE RULE SETS

Definition: A rule set is a combination of rules from a group of different sources. For example, PHB 1, 2 and 3 combine to create the list of classes.

Official Rules: The official rule set is the combination of all the published rules. This includes the core rulebooks, supplements, campaign setting materials, box sets, etc. D&D 4E was published from June 2008 to May 2012. On July 2010 the "essentials" revision was created. Several errata were also published during the whole time period.

Core Rules: The core rules are defined as the subset of rules from the official rules that are used by the MGX. They consist of all the rules found in the sources listed ahead. On top of this there are many house rules in this system that override their respective core rules where appropriate. For example, none of the PC weapons listed in the core rules are used, instead the weapons are entirely recreated, and trust me – they are awesome!

Core Rulebooks

- Player's Handbook (PHB), Player's Handbook 2 (PHB2), Player's Handbook 3 (PHB3)
- Dungeon Master Guide (DMG), Dungeon Master Guide 2 (DMG2)
- Monster Manual (MM1), Monster Manual 2 (MM2), Monster Manual 3 (MM3)
- Arcane Power (AP), Divine Power (DP), Martial Power (MP), Primal Power (PP), Psionic Power (SP)
- [ToDo] Errata & Updates: http://dnd4.wikia.com/wiki/List_of_updates

Potential Inclusions

- Adventurer's Vault, Adventurer's Vault 2, Mordenkainen's Magnificent Emporium
- Manual of the Planes, Open Grave
- [ToDo] Pre-made Adventures

Exclusions

- Martial Power 2 (1 is enough)
- Any campaign materials (the WBG is used to build a MGX campaign)

Essentials Update

Major Update: The essentials update was published in July 2010. It revised several character classes and rebalanced the monster traits system. However, it is still backwards compatible with the previous material. This is unlike editions 3.0 and 3.5, which are not compatible. The new classes are compatible because they are just simplifications of the existing classes. Therefore, just excluding them from the core rule set is enough. The monster update is actually not compatible because the monsters got significant damage bonuses. Therefore it behooves to have some mechanism that handles this discrepancy in the rule set.

Monster Update: The monster update affected several properties of a monster. These include initiative, attack bonus, and damage profile. The monster's defenses and hit points were not changed. The changes in the update should be compared to DMG 184.

The "Monster Vault" book provides hundreds of new monsters built with the updated system. Some of them are new, but others are updates to monsters from MM1 and MM2. The updates are identifiable by the fact that they have the same name in the two books. Research was done on a spreadsheet to compare the original monsters with their updates. Different monsters were affected in different ways and there is no pattern by monster role, attack type, or anything else. Here is a summary of the findings:

- about 10% of monsters' initiative was modified
- about 50% of monsters' attack bonus was increased
- about 95% of monsters' damage was increased

The MGX Special Rule

Special Rule: This new rule is a very important update to the 4E encounter system. For every encounter, the number of monsters is equal to the number of characters +1. This increases the difficulty of encounters, which is justified with the following.

- In the MGX, PC's have access to new more powerful weapons and feats.
- The essentials update is proof that the early monster books are unbalanced and too easy.
- The game is easy because a monster group of the party's level can be destroyed by the party without using their daily powers. It also gets easier as the tiers go up, as paragon paths are ridiculously powerful.
- The DM's job in playing strategically in combat is much harder than the players' job.
- Note that magic items are already rarer in the MGX than in the official rules. Though this is not enough to make the game difficult and engaging.
- Note that increasing the number of monsters by 1 is better than increasing the level of the encounter by 1. This is because less total monster XP is added.

CHAPTER TWO

PLAYER CHARACTERS

HOUSE RULES

DM OFFICERS

Task Master: Responsible for overseeing the party actions. The task master keeps the party action descriptions at hand and guides the party through each step.

Calendar Officer: AKA the Sleep-Meister! Responsible for writing in the "Party Action" roster. The calendar officer records the basic information about each task the party does. This information includes quest name, task number, task result, etc.

Board Officer: Responsible for setting up the combat board. The rules for this are in "Chapter 2 Encounters".

Character Creation

New Characters

Starting Campaign: To create a new character at the beginning of a campaign, follow the character creation guide as is.

Existing Campaign: To create a new character in an existing campaign, follow the character creation guide with the following modifications.

- The new character cannot have the same race or class as any previous character of the same player.
- The new character starts with enough XP to be of the lowest level among all existing party members.
- The new characters gets an additional amount of gold equal to the lowest amount of gold among all existing party members.
- The new character gets a number of magic items equal to the lowest number of magic items among all existing party members. To create the character's magic items, create a Magic Vendor inventory of the character's level -1. To create an inventory, see the "StoryTelling System" rulebook Chapter 1 "Party Actions". The player then chooses the items from the inventory. For every 7 character levels beyond the first 7, create an additional inventory to choose from.
- The new character gets a number of faction values equal to the faction values of a random existing character. However, the new character can switch the values to around to any factions that they choose. That is, the number and value of factions values must be the same, but the factions themselves can be different.

Level Up: Some characters may start with enough XP to be higher than level 1. In such a case, first create the character as level 1, then level them up. PHB 27 has the level up guide. Additionally, PHB3 164 lists the utility skill powers.

CREATION GUIDE

The Guide: This character creation guide is an improvement upon and replaces the core rules guide (PHB 14). It compiles rules from the entire rule set, including classes, races, skills, etc. It also has some house rules for character creation, such as starting XP and equipment.

Character Sheet: The Character Sheet must be used to record and maintain the player character. It is shown in PHB 30 with keyed numbers. Those numbers are used in this guide and referred to with the # sign. Therefore #1 refers to "Character Name". It is available on the website under "Rosters".

1] Class: To choose your class, refer to the next section "Class List". All abilities granted from class, except for powers, should be recorded now.

- Proficiencies: Record on #23. Also see 1B ahead.
- Defenses: Record on #8. The bonus is of Class type.
- Class Features: Record on #21.
- Rituals: Record on #29. Not all classes have rituals.

1B] Proficiencies: This system uses a different list of weapons from the core rules. The new weapon list is found in the Equipment section ahead. The following proficiencies are modified in the new rules to suit the changed weapons and feat system.

- Rogue: simple melee, simple ranged, military light blade
- Wizard: simple melee, simple ranged
- Bard: simple melee, military light blade, military heavy blade, simple & military ranged
- Shaman: simple melee, military spear
- Monk: monk unarmed strike, simple melee, simple ranged
- Dwarf: simple & military mace, military hammer
- Elf: simple & military bow
- Eladrin: military heavy blade

2] Race: To choose your race, refer to the next heading "Race List". You can choose any of the standard or rare races. However, only 2 characters in the party may be of a rare race. To play an evil race, permission is required from the DM. Record the following traits which are based on race.

- Languages: Record on #22.
- Skill Bonuses: Record on #20.
- Defenses: Record on #8, use Misc type.
- Proficiencies: Record on #23. Also see step 1B.
- Racial Powers: Record on #24.

3] Basics

- Character Name: Based on the character's race. Record on #1.
- Age, Gender, Height, Weight: Based on the character's race. Record on #5.
- Alignment: PHB 19. Record on #6.

4] Starting XP: Characters start with 1d20 x 50 + 500 XP. This may put them at 1st or 2nd level. If the character is 2nd level, first create them as normal, then level them up. Also, remember that you should keep your level hidden from the other players.

5] Attributes: Refer to PHB 17 and use Method 2. Record on #10.

6] Class Powers: Your powers are available in the class's description. Choose powers that fit well with your attributes and weapon. Also the Power books, such as Martial Power, have more powers for each class. Refer to the Advancement Table (PHB 29) for your character's number of powers. Record on #24.

7] Skills: Skills are explained in PHB 178. Your character's number of skill is set by their class. Characters may train in new skills with feats. In this expansion, skills are much more important than in the regular arbitrary D&D because they are used for routine tasks, like buying magic items. Please see the next section "Enhanced Skills" for some guidance in choosing skills. Record on #20 your trained skills and skill totals.

8] Feats: None of the core rules feats are available in the MGX. See the next section "New Feats" for all the new rules on feats. The feat list is found on the website under the Expansion Rules -> Feat List. Choose your feats now and record on #23.

9] Equipment

- Characters start with 300 gold and 1 healing potion (PHB 255).
- Characters may purchase any number of mundane items. The full list of mundane items is presented in the "Enhanced Equipment" section ahead.
- Characters must purchase 1 suit of armor; 1 weapon or implement; and 1 standard adventurer's kit.
- Any money not spent goes to the stash #30.
- Record all items on #28 or #25.
- Armor check penalties apply to skills. Record on #20.
- Encumbrance from equipment is not a rule in 4E (PHB 222).

10] Other Properties

- Initiative: Record on #7. PHB 267.
- Hit Points: The HP profile is given by class. Record on #13.
- Defenses: Record on #8 and compute all totals (PHB 274).
- Movement: Base speed is given by race. Speed is lowered by armor. Record on #9.
- Combat Workspaces: Use Attack Workspace (#12), Damage Workspace (#18) and Basic Attacks (#19) to calculate and summarize your most frequent attacks. These should be your at-will powers (from class) and basic attacks (PHB 287). Note that only powers that have the weapon/implement keyword benefit from equipment proficiency or magic enhancement bonus (PHB 55).

Class List

Classes by Role & Power Source

	Defender	**Leader**	**Striker**	**Controller**
Martial	Fighter	Warlord	Ranger Rogue	
Divine	Paladin	Cleric Runepriest	Avenger	Invoker
Arcane		Bard	Sorcerer Warlock	Wizard
Primal	Warden	Shaman	Barbarian	Druid Seeker
Psionic	Battlemind	Ardent	Monk	Psion

Classes by Role

Role	**Class**	**Source**	**Book**
Defender	Fighter	Martial	PHB
	Paladin	Divine	PHB
	Warden	Primal	PHB2
	Battlemind	Psionic	PHB3
Leader	Cleric	Divine	PHB
	Warlord	Martial	PHB
	Bard	Arcane	PHB2
	Shaman	Primal	PHB2
	Ardent	Psionic	PHB3
	Runepriest	Divine	PHB3

Role	**Class**	**Source**	**Book**
Striker	Ranger	Martial	PHB
	Rogue	Martial	PHB
	Warlock	Arcane	PHB
	Avenger	Divine	PHB2
	Barbarian	Primal	PHB2
	Sorcerer	Arcane	PHB2
	Monk	Psionic	PHB3
Controller	Wizard	Arcane	PHB
	Druid	Primal	PHB2
	Invoker	Divine	PHB2
	Psion	Psionic	PHB3
	Seeker	Primal	PHB3

Race List

Standard Races

Race	Attributes	Powers	Book
Dwarf	Con +2 Str +2 or Wis +2	Encumbered Speed, Stand Your Ground	PHB 36
Eladrin	Int +2 Dex +2 or Cha +2	Eladrin Education, Trance, Fey Step	PHB 38
Elf	Dex +2 Int +2 or Wis +2	Elven Accuracy, Wild Step	PHB 40
Gnome	Int +2 Dex +2 or Cha +2	Master Trickster, Reactive Stealth, Fade Away	PHB2 10 MM 276
Goliath	Str +2 Con +2	Powerful Athlete, Stone's Endurance	PHB2 12
Halfling	Dex +2 Con +2 or Cha +2	Nimble Reaction, Second Chance	PHB 44
Human	Any +2	Bonus Feat, Bonus Skill, Human Defense	PHB 46

Evil Races

Race	Attributes	Powers	Book
Bugbear			MM 276
Bullywug			MM2 220
Drow			MM 276
Duergar			MM2 220
Gnoll			MM 276
Goblin			MM 276
Hobgoblin			MM 276
Kobold			MM 276
Minotaur			PHB3 10 MM 276
Orc			MM 276
Shardmind			PHB3 12

Rare Races

Race	Attributes	Powers	Book
Deva	Wis +2 Int +2 or Cha +2	Astral Resistance, Memory of Lifetimes	PHB2 8
Doppleganger	Int +2 Cha +2	Change Shape	MM 276
Dragonborn	Cha +2 Str +2 or Con +2	Dragonborn Fury, Dragon Breath	PHB 34
Githyanki	Int +2 Con +2	Danger Sense, Telekinetic Leap	MM 276
Githzerai	Wis +2 Dex +2 or Int +2	Danger Sense, Iron Mind	PHB3 8 MM 276
Half-Elf	Con +2 Wis +2 or Cha +2	Dilettante/Knack for Success	PHB 42
Half-Orc	Dex +2 Str +2 or Con +2	HO Resilience, Swift Charge, Furious Assault	PHB2 14
Kenku	Dex +2 Cha +2	Flock Effect, Mimicry	MM2 220
Shadar-Kai	Dex +2 Int +2	Shadow Jaunt	MM 276
Shifter	Str +2, Wis +2 Dex +2, Wis +2	Longtooth Shifting, Razorclaw Shifting	PHB2 16 MM 276
Tiefling	Cha +2 Con +2 or Int +2	Bloodhunt, Infernal Wrath	PHB 48
Warforged	Con +2 Str+2 or Int +2	Unsleeping Watcher, Warforged Resolve	MM 276
Wilden	Wis +2 Dex +2 or Con +2	Nature's Aspect	PHB3 14

ENHANCED SKILLS

Expansion Skills: Skills are much more important in the MGX than any other RPG. They are used to drive nearly every aspect of the story and exploration. They're used to find quests, do quests, turn in quests, buy & sell magic items, loot combat rewards, navigate the world, gather information, etc. The following tables list the skill uses. They present the skill uses in the core rules and some of the uses in the expansion. The skills are divided into groups of similar skills. Generally, a character should have 1 skill from each group.

Social Group

Skill	Attrib	Core Use	Expansion Use
Bluff	Cha	• Fast talk, gamble, etc • Combat x2	• Earn Income, bonus
Diplomacy	Cha	• Persuade, haggle, etiquette	• Haggle Challenge
Insight	Wis	• Read social situation • Detect illusion	• Karma Challenge • Search for Bounties
Intimidate	Cha	• Influence others	• Haggle Challenge
Streetwise	Cha	• Collect information	• Karma Challenge • Search for Bounties

Knowledge Group

Skill	Attrib	Core Use	Expansion Use
Arcana	Int	• Arcana Knowledge • Monster Knowledge (E, F, S) • Detect Magic	• Find Landmark • Loot (E, F, S beast)
Heal (Herbalism) (Forensics)	Wis	• Combat x3 • Treat Disease	• Search for Bounties • Setup Camp
History (Engineering) (Cartography)	Int	• Chronological events • Historical explanation	• Earn Income, bonus • Loot (construct, trap)
Religion	Int	• Religion Knowledge • Monster Knowledge (I, U)	• Karma Challenge • Loot (undead, immortal)

Exploration Group

Skill	Attrib	Core Use	Expansion Use
Dungeoneering	Wis	• Dungeoneering Knowledge • Monster Knowledge (A) • Forage	• Travel (underground) • Loot (A beast)
Nature	Wis	• Nature Knowledge • Monster Knowledge (N) • Forage • Handle Animal	• Travel (surface) • Loot (N, F, S beast)
Perception	Wis	• Oppose Stealth • Find tracks	• Find Landmark • Combat setup
Stealth	Dex	• Hide	• Setup Camp • Combat setup

Physical Group

Skill	Attrib	Core Use	Expansion Use
Acrobatics	Dex	• Acrobatic Stunt • Balance • Escape from Grab • Reduce Falling Damage	• Chase encounter
Athletics	Str	• Climb • Escape from Grab • Jump • Swim	• Chase encounter
Endurance	Con	• Resist environment effects • Resist disease	• Chase encounter
Thievery	Dex	• Disable Trap • Open Lock • Pick Pocket • Sleight of Hand	• Loot (humanoid w/equip)

New Feats

Core Feats: Feats from the core rules are quite terrible and worthless. It's a pain to read through dozens of unusable feats to find the least worse ones. Initially the plan was to combine all the feats from the included core rules in a spreadsheet and over time improve them all. However, there are too many of them, and it's too much crap. The better option then becomes to throw out all the core rules feats and create a new set of feats.

New Rules: Feats are no longer divided into the game tiers. Instead, each feat can be taken once per tier, provided that there is still a benefit and that the prerequisites have been met. That is, you could take Weapon Focus at level 1 and at level 11, giving a total attack +2 bonus. Note that some feats will not provide their benefit more than once, such as proficiency feats.

Feat Groups: The feats are divided into groups based on their functionality. General feats can be taken by any character. Race/Class feats can only be taken by characters that meet said requirements.

- Offense: attack roll, damage roll, attack of opportunity
- Defense: bonus to AC, bonus to defenses, heal damage, temporary HP, saving throw bonuses
- Other Combat: movement, initiative, control abilities
- Adventuring: skills, rituals

Feat List: There are around 130 new feats. Since feats can have class or race requirements, each character should have around 30 to 40 feats that make sense for them. The feat list is found on the website under the Expansion Rules -> Feat List.

NEW EQUIPMENT

EQUIPMENT RULES

Mundane Equipment: This is the full list of mundane equipment.

- Weapons & Armor: Refer to the house rules in this section. They override the standard tables.
- Superior Implements: PHB3 195.
- Adventuring Gear: PHB 222, PHB2 197.
- Consumables: PHB 255. PHB3 213. A merchant, from the Visit Common Merchant party action, has 1 item of each type available per day.

Merchants: The party action Visit Common Merchant allows the party to go purchase mundane items. Merchants have a virtually infinite supply of weapons, armor, implements and adventuring gear. However they only have 1 of each type of consumable per day. Also, the maximum level of consumable they have is their level +4.

New Weapons: The core rules weapon list system has some weapons that are strictly inferior to others. To correct this, and to give each weapon group a theme, an entirely new set of weapons was created. None of the weapons in the core rules exist - only the weapons listed here exist. However, the weapon *groups* remain the same as in the core rules, so that part of the rules is unchanged.

Reference: The new weapon set can also be found in a standalone file on the website at Expansion Rules -> Weapons & Armor.

New Armor: The armors remain unchanged in this system. However, their prices are adjusted to match the system's economy.

Armor & Shields

Type	AC	Check	Speed	Price
Cloth	0	-	-	30gp
Leather	+2	-	-	50gp
Hide	+3	-1	-	70gp
Chainmail	+6	-1	-1	100gp
Scale Armor	+7	-	-1	140gp
Plate Armor	+8	-2	-1	200gp
Light Shield	+1	-	-	25gp
Heavy Shield	+2	-2	-	55gp

Small Characters: Small characters may use any type of weapon a medium character can use.

New Weapon Properties

Accurate: When rolling any attack with the weapon, reroll once per round any natural result of 1-4.

Brutal: When rolling the weapon's damage, reroll any die that is equal to or lower than the brutal value of the weapon. Reroll the die until the value exceeds the weapon's brutal value, and use the new value.

Crippling: When any attack hits with the weapon, the user may replace dealing damage to the target with target becomes slowed (save ends).

Defensive: When the weapon is equipped, the user gets AC +1 against melee attacks.

Heavy Thrown: The weapon may be used to make basic ranged attacks. However, it uses Str on the attack and damage rolls.

High Crit: The weapon has two abilities. First, it increases the critical precision by 1. Second, on a critical hit, the weapon deals some extra damage. This extra damage is in addition to any other critical damage bonuses. As with other damage that is added to critical hits, this extra damage is not maximized as part of the critical hit. The damage varies by level:

- 1[W] extra damage at 1st–10th levels;
- 2[W] extra damage at 11th–20th levels;
- 3[W] extra damage at 21st–30th levels.

Light Thrown: The weapon may be used to make basic ranged attacks.

Off-hand: The weapon may be equipped in addition to another weapon if the user has a feat which allows that.

Reach: When the weapon is equipped, the user's melee reach is increased by +1". This does not increase the range at which they may make opportunity attacks (see threatening reach) or flank.

Staggering: When any attack hits with the weapon, the user may replace dealing damage to the target with target becomes dazed (save ends).

Melee Weapon Groups

Light Blade Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Simple	1H	Dagger	+3	1d6	—	30gp	
Military	1H	Rapier	+3	1d8	—	60gp	
	1H	Short Sword	+3	1d6	5/10	60gp	Off-hand, Light Thrown
Superior	1H	Wakizashi	+3	1d8	—	110gp	Accurate
	1H	Katar	+3	1d8	—	110gp	High Crit
	1H	Gladius	+3	1d8	5/10	110gp	Off-hand, Light Thrown

Heavy Blade Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	1H	Longsword	+3	1d8	—	60gp	
	2H	Greatsword	+3	1d10	—	90gp	
Superior	1H	Broadsword	+3	1d8	—	110gp	Brutal 2
	2H	Falchion	+3	1d10	—	150gp	Brutal 3
	2H	Nodaichi	+3	1d10	—	150gp	High Crit

Spear Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	1H	Spontoon	+3	1d8	—	60gp	
	2H	Spear	+3	1d10	—	90gp	
Superior	1H	Trident	+3	1d8	—	110gp	Crippling
	2H	Awl Pike	+3	1d10	—	150gp	Reach
	1H	Javelin	+3	1d8	5/10	110gp	Heavy Thrown

Axe Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	1H	Battleaxe	+2	1d10	—	60gp	
	2H	Greataxe	+2	1d12	—	90gp	
Superior	1H	Waraxe	+2	1d10	—	110gp	Brutal 2
	2H	Execution Axe	+2	1d12	—	150gp	Brutal 3
	2H	Urgrosh	+2	1d12	—	150gp	Staggering

Pick Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	1H	Kama	+2	1d10	—	60gp	
	1H	Sickle	+2	1d8	—	60gp	Off-hand, Light Thrown
Superior	1H	War Pick	+2	1d10	—	110gp	High Crit
	1H	Kukri	+2	1d10	—	110gp	Off-hand, Light Thrown
	2H	Scythe	+2	1d12	—	150gp	High Crit

Polearm Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	2H	Halberd	+2	1d12	—	90gp	
	2H	Voulge	+1	2d6	—	90gp	
Superior	2H	Guisarme	+2	1d12	—	150gp	Reach
	2H	Spetum	+2	1d10	—	150gp	Reach, Accurate
	2H	Military Fork	+2	1d10	—	150gp	Reach, Crippling

Mace Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Simple	1H	Light Mace	+2	1d8	—	30gp	
	1H	Spiked Club	+1	1d10	—	30gp	
	2H	Quarterstaff	+2	1d10	—	50gp	
	2H	Greatclub	+1	1d12	—	50gp	
Military	1H	Mace	+2	1d8	—	60gp	Defensive
	1H	Billy club	+2	1d6	—	60gp	Defensive, Off-hand
Superior	1H	Pernach	+2	1d8	—	110gp	Defensive, Brutal 2
	1H	Cudgel	+2	1d8	—	110gp	Defensive, Off-hand
	2H	Morningstar	+2	1d10	—	150gp	Defensive, Brutal 3

Hammer Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	1H	Warhammer	+2	1d8	—	60gp	Defensive
	2H	Maul	+2	1d10	—	90gp	Defensive
Superior	1H	Craghammer	+2	1d8	—	110gp	Defensive, Staggering
	2H	Mordenkrad	+2	1d10	—	150gp	Defensive, Staggering
	2H	Slamodin	+2	1d10	—	150gp	Defensive, High Crit

Flail Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	1H	Horseman's Flail	+2	1d8	—	60gp	Defensive
	2H	Footman's Flail	+2	1d10	—	90gp	Defensive
Superior	1H	Scourge	+2	1d8	—	110gp	Defensive, Crippling
	1H	Triple-headed Flail	+2	1d8	—	110gp	Defensive, Accurate
	2H	Spiked Chain	+2	1d10	—	150gp	Defensive, Crippling

Range Weapon Groups

Sling Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Simple	1H	Sling	+2	1d6	8/16	30gp	
Military	1H	Sling Shot	+2	1d8	10/20	60gp	
Superior	1H	Bolas	+2	1d8	12/24	110gp	Crippling

Crossbow Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Simple	2H	Light Crossbow	+2	1d10	8/16	50gp	Load Move
Military	2H	Heavy Crossbow	+2	1d12	10/20	90gp	Load Move
	1H	Hand Crossbow	+2	1d8	10/20	60gp	Load Minor
Superior	2H	Vise Crossbow	+2	1d12	12/24	150gp	Load Move, Brutal 3
	2H	Rept Crossbow	+2	1d12	12/24	150gp	Load Minor

Bow Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Damage	Range	Price	Properties
Military	2H	Longbow	+3	1d8	10/20	90gp	
Superior	2H	Composite Bow	+3	1d10	12/24	150gp	
	2H	Flight Bow	+3	1d8	12/24	150gp	Accurate
	2H	Daikyu	+3	1d8	12/24	150gp	High Crit

Implement Group

Profic	Hand	Weapon	Prof.	Dmg	Range	Price	Properties
Implement	1H	Implement	+0	-	-	30gp	
Superior	1H	Sup Implement	+0	-	-	150gp	See PHB3 195, 219

Henchmen

Definition: A henchman is a monster entry that is a sidekick of a player character (aka the master). They participate in encounters, skill challenges and anything else the party may do. There are 2 types of henchmen: companion, and mercenary.

Allies are loosely defined in the DMG. They share in the XP and treasure rewards of the party. The MGX has much better rules. The party must pay up front for henchmen, but henchmen do not take any rewards away from the party.

Requirements: A master can only have 1 henchman at a time. A henchman monster cannot be a minion or solo. If a henchman is an elite, then they count as 1 level higher for purposes of the master' level requirement.

Encounters: Henchmen participate in encounters just as any other model. The player has full control over their character's henchmen. A henchman has a number of healing surges equal to 3 + Con modifier. A henchmen unit rolls initiative separately from the player character. If a henchman dies, they roll death saves the same as a character (PHB 295) with 2 exceptions. First, if they fail 2 death saves they die. Second, if they are healed from dying, they do not regain consciousness until after a short rest.

Skill Challenges: Each henchmen unit can assist once with a skill challenge. A henchman is trained with the skills that are listed in its monster entry.

Upgrade: Henchmen do not get XP and do not level up. Their equipment and properties do not change. Companions and party bonus henchmen have special rules for being upgraded.

Companion: A companion is an animal that is bonded with their master. They can be bought at a beast trainer in settlement. Once bought, they remain with their master until they are upgraded, die, or get dismissed. A companion must be a monster of type “beast” or “magical beast”. Its level must be equal to or less than the master’s level -1.

A companion’s special bond allows it to always be with its master, but also comes with some costs. The companion must be taken care of once a week. Taking care of companions requires 1 time block and a payment of the companion monster’s gold value x 50%. If a master doesn’t care for their companion in a particular week, then in the following week the companion is not available for encounters or anything else. If the master then takes care of the companion, the companion becomes available at the start of the following week. If a companion is not taken care of for 2 weeks in a row, they leave or die.

Mercenary: A mercenary is a humanoid that sells their services for money. They can be contracted at the mercenary barracks in settlement. Once contracted they remain with their master through 1 encounter. A mercenary must be a monster of type “humanoid” and with ally group “alliance” or “mercenary”. Its level must be equal to or less than the master’s level -1.

CHAPTER THREE

ENCOUNTERS

COMBAT HOUSE RULES

SETUP THE COMBAT BOARD

Setup: Follow these steps to build the combat board.

1] Terrain: Based on the combat's location, choose a biome on the next table.

2] Board Base: The base is a 2' x 2' area. This is 24" on the side, which is equivalent to 24 squares. For most biomes, use a green base. For Downtown, Streets, and all underground biomes use a brown base.

3] Features: Based on the biome, different features will be on the board. Terrain features are separate pieces of felt which have rules as described next. Placing them on the battle board is an art form.

- First, pick out the number of features as indicated in the next table. For example: if the biome is forest, get 3 crags out of the 8 available from storage. Then do the same for the other terrain features of the forest.
- Second, place the chosen terrain features on the board. This is done by placing 2-4 terrain features on each quarter of the board. A terrain feature can never be on top of another one. There should be a 2"-3" space between terrains, though 1" is the hard limit.

Board Terrain Features

Biome	Impassable		Difficult		Hindering
Forest	Crag x3	Pit x2	Woods x5		Vengevine x2
Jungle	Crag x3		Woods x4	Rocks x3	Fungal Bloom x2
Swamp	Crag x2		Woods x4	Waterway x4	Quicksand x2
Plains	Crag x2	Pit x3	Rocks x5		Quicksand x2
Savannah	Crag x3		Rocks x4	Woods x3	Vengevine x2
Marsh	Crag x2		Rocks x3	Waterway x5	Fungal Bloom x2
Downtown	Building x5	Wall x4	Waterway x3		Vengevine x2
Streets	Building x4	Pit x3	Rocks x3		Quicksand x2
Outskirts	Building x3		Woods x4	Waterway x2	Fungal Bloom x2
Tunnels	Wall x10		Rocks x3	Woods x2	Vengevine x2
Cavern	Wall x8	Crag x2	Woods x4		Quicksand x2
Sub River	Wall x8	Pit x2	Waterway x4		Fungal Bloom x2

Impassable Terrain

Crag
Shape: Rectilinear Color: Cashmere Tan
Description: A crag is an elevated area, such as a hill or rocky outcropping.
Geometry: A crag blocks line-of-sight and movement with its walls. It is 4" high and at the top is a walking platform similar to the ground.
Climb: The sides can be climbed to reach the top platform. The climb DC is set by the encounter's level, with a skill +2 bonus.
Line-of-sight: If an attacking model's line-of-sight (PHB 273) is partially blocked by the crag, the target model gets superior cover (PHB 280).

Wood Building
Shape: Rectilinear Color: Copper
Description: The building is made of wood, or some otherwise sturdy material.
Geometry: The building is formed by walls on the edge that are 3" high. There is also a top platform which is the roof. Thus it is hollow and can be entered by any model through the doors/windows on the terrain piece.
Climb: The building can be climbed with a DC set by the level of the encounter. The walls are climbed with a skill -2 penalty and lead to the roof. Moving on the roof also requires a climb check with a skill +2 bonus.

Wall
Shape: Rectilinear Color: Silver Grey
Description: The wall can work in 2 different ways. On the surface it is a solid stone wall 4" high. In the underground, it serves to mark the edge of the tunnels and caverns.
Surface: The wall can be climbed to reach its narrow top. The climb DC is set by the encounter's level, with a skill -2 penalty. It is possible to move atop the wall, however it requires a climb test with DC set by the encounter's level.
Underground: In the underground a tunnel wall is 3" high and a cavern wall is 8" high. The wall can be climbed with a DC set by the encounter's level, with a skill +2 bonus. The ceiling can also be climbed, with a skill -5 penalty.

Pit
Shape: Rectilinear Color: Black
Description: A pit is hollow hole on the ground, either dug up or a natural formation.
Geometry: The depth of a pit is equal to the length of its longest side. Falling rules are in PHB 284.
Climb: The sides can be climbed with a DC set by the encounter level, with a skill +2 bonus.
Line-of-sight: A model inside the pit has line-of-sight blocked to all areas outside the pit.

DIFFICULT TERRAIN

Waterway
Shape: Curvy Color: Brilliant Blue
Description: The area is a river or small lake with somewhat of a current.
Geometry: It is 1" deep.
Difficult Ground: Moving 1" costs 3 Speed points.
No Jumping: A model cannot jump while inside or 2" from a waterway.

Rocks
Shape: Curvy Color: Silver Grey
Description: The area is littered with large rocks, or old ruins.
Cover vs Ranged: If an attacking model's line-of-sight for a ranged attack (PHB 273) goes through the terrain, the target model gets superior cover (PHB 280).

Woods
Shape: Curvy Color: Apple Green
Geometry: The area is covered with large trees and ground foliage. It is 6" high.
Movement: The terrain is difficult ground where 1" of movement costs 2 Speed points. A model cannot jump or fly within the terrain.
Cover: A model within the terrain gets cover against melee and ranged attacks.
Climb: Anywhere within the terrain can be climbed, with a DC given by the encounter's level. A model can climb vertically or horizontally.

Hindering Terrain

Vengevine
Shape: Indented Color: Red
Description: The vengevine is made of thick brambles and thorny vines.
Deal Damage: Whenever a model enters or starts their turn in the terrain, they can take damage. The model must pass an Acrobatics test against a DC based on the encounter's level. If they pass the test, they take no damage. If they fail, they take medium normal damage based on the encounter's level (DMG 42).
Vengeful Fury: A model that took damage this round from the terrain gets a damage +3 bonus per tier for this round.

Fungal Bloom
Shape: Indented Color: Orchid
Description: The area is covered in slimy mushrooms or slippery leaves.
Don't Blink: Whenever a model enters or starts their turn in the terrain, they can be teleported. The model must pass an Endurance test against a DC based on the encounter's level. If they pass the test, they remain in place. If they fail, they are teleported 1d6" in a random direction and their movement ends.
Vertigo: A model inside the terrain gets melee reach +1".

Quicksand
Shape: Indented Color:
Description: The area has very unstable terrain.
Pull Down: Whenever a model enters or starts their turn in the terrain, they may get pulled down. The model must pass an Athletics test against a DC based on the encounter's level. If they pass the test, they may move as normal. If they fail, they lose their move action for the round.
Deep Down: A model inside the terrain gets AC +2.

ENCOUNTER: COMBAT

SETUP COMBAT

Requirements: The party is ready for combat. The monster encounter group has been created. Models are chosen for both groups. And the combat board is setup.

Setup Groups: This section standardizes the process for setting up combat, since the core rules only provide guidelines (DMG 36). This procedure makes initial model placement and surprise rounds streamlined and balanced.

Group Awareness: For both groups, determine their awareness of the encounter. Any skill modifiers provided here apply to all setup rolls going forward.

- Ready: The group is ready but not expecting any trouble. It may be traveling overland, on patrol, hunting, or guarding a location. No bonuses apply.
- Resting by Shifts: There is 1 model on lookout. All others are asleep or otherwise busy. The other group gets a Stealth +2 bonus.
- Prepared: The group has prior knowledge of the other group's movements. They get a Perception +5 and Stealth +5 bonuses.

Deployment: The party rolls a skill challenge to determine the setup order. The results of the challenge determine whether the party sets up first or second. A model has *stealth* if it's a character trained in stealth, or a monster that has a stealth value listed.

Deployment Challenge

Skills:	Perception
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By encounter level
Special:	Challenge cannot be assisted

Deployment Results

Results	Effects
0 S, 2 F	Player party sets up first. Party is constrained.
1 S, 2 F	Player party sets up first.
2 S, 1 F	Monster group sets up first.
2 S, 0 F	Monster group sets up first. Group is constrained.

Setup First Group: The first group is setup based on the following rules.

- If the group is constrained, the first model must be setup within 2" of the center of the board. Otherwise, the first model can be setup within 6" of the center.
- All other models must be setup within 3" of the first model. Except models that have stealth may be up to 8" away.

Setup Second Group: The second group is setup based on the following rules.

- If the first group is *not* constrained, models of the second group may be setup up to 8" away from an enemy model.
- If the first group is constrained, models of the second group may be setup up to 7" away from an enemy model.
- The first model of the second group must have line-of-sight to the first model of the first group.
- All other models of the second group must be setup within 3" of the first model. Except models that have stealth may be up to 8" away.

Ambush: Each group now chooses whether they want to try to ambush the other group by using stealth to get a surprise round. The group that has the lowest stealth skill must decide whether to ambush or not first. A group's stealth skill is the highest skill value among all models in the group.

Ambush Challenge

Skills:	Stealth
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	The best passive Perception among enemy group. If enemy has Stealth, may use Stealth skill instead.
Special:	Challenge cannot be assisted
Special:	Penalty for each model that doesn't have stealth: • Stealth -2 plus any armor check penalty

Ambush Results

Results	Effects
0 S, 2 F	The enemy group gets a surprise round instead.
1 S, 2 F	No change.
2 S, 1 F	The ambushing group gets 1 surprise round.
2 S, 0 F	The ambushing group gets 2 surprise rounds. The ambushed group gets limited actions on both rounds.

COMBAT NEW RULES

Combat Core Rules

- Character Turn: PHB 268
- Actions: PHB 289
- Movement: PHB 282
- Conditions: PHB 277
- Damaging Objects: DMG 65
- Damage Expressions: DMG 42
- Monster Abilities: MM1 7

Initiative Convergence: The normal initiative rules (PHB 267) are overridden by these rules. Models roll initiative as (highest die of 2d20) + initiative bonus.

Extended Critical Precision: The normal critical rules are in PHB 276. These house rules extend the precision of the critical roll based on the level of the model attacking as shown on the next table. The precision to get an automatic hit is not changed.

Level	Crit Roll
1 – 10	18+
11 – 20	17+
21 – 25	16+
26 - 30	15+

Charge: The core charge rules (PHB 287) are abysmally bad and overwritten here. A charge is when a model begins their move outside of the target's threatened area, ends their move with the target in their threatened area, and declares a melee attack against the target. Any melee attacks declared during a charge get an attack +2 bonus.

Sticky Death Saves: The death save rules are in "Death and Dying" (PHB 295). A character must spend a healing surge to roll a death save, otherwise the save is failed. Additionally, failed death saves remain on a character until they get an extended rest.

Emergency Combat Healing: The heal skill allows characters to use *first aid* in combat (PHB 185). The DC of any first aid check is given by the encounter's level on the "Level Lookup Table".

Jump: The long jump is covered under the Athletics skill (PHB 182) and is overwritten here. A model jumps a horizontal distance of squares equal to 1d2 + their Athletics bonus divided by 5, round down. Running jumps do not help.

Special New Rule: For purposes of building encounters, a monster counts as 1 level lower than the value in the monster book. This change is meant to balance the monster level with the sweeping changes used in this expansion. To learn more, refer to Chapter 1.

ENCOUNTER: CHASE

The chase is an encounter, like combat is an encounter. However, instead of using the characters' offense and defense, it's focused on their movement abilities.

The Chase: A chase comes from a combat where one of the groups decides to flee instead of fight. The group that flees is known as the *flyers*, whereas the pursuers are the *chasers*. This decision happens before the combat board is setup. The chasers may choose not to pursue and let the other group go.

The combat is canceled, and a whole new mini-game applies. The player turn is more flexible than combat. Instead of being on a grid, the models are on a numbered line. During their turn, a model moves up the line, and uses their powers to make extra moves. The group that ends up further up than the other wins the encounter.

Turn Order: The game consists of *rounds* in which each model (character or monster) takes their *turn*. Each round, the players and DM switch off activating one of their models. The group with the highest number of models goes first. If the number of models are tied, decide the first player arbitrarily. When it is the party's turn, they may choose any character to go at any time. The turn order can also change from one round to the next. Once every model has taken an action, the game goes to the next round.

Objective: The winner of the chase is the group that is furthest up at the end of the encounter. The encounter is over after exactly 4 turns. To measure the distance of a group, take the average position of each of its models. The group with the highest position wins the encounter.

If the chasers win, they run down and destroy the flyers. If the party is the chasers and wins, they get the encounter rewards, including the treasure. If the monsters are the chasers, then each party member must roll a death save challenge.

If the flyers win, they get away from the chasers and are unharmed. If the party is the flyers then they get the encounter rewards, except for the treasure. If the monsters are the flyers, then the party counts as losing the encounter.

Death Save Challenge

Skills:	Roll a death save (PHB 295)
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	3 successes before 3 failures
DC:	N/A

Results	**Effects**
0 S, 3 F	Character death.
1 S, 3 F	Character death.
2 S, 3 F	Lose 1 random magic item. Lose all healing surges.
3 S, 2 F	Lose 6 healing surges.
3 S, 1 F	Lose 3 healing surges.
3 S, 0 F	Character alive.

The Track: Just as combat takes place in a grid, the chase takes place on a track numbered 0 and up. A model's *position* on the track is the number they are on. All models start at some position on the track and move forward indefinitely until the encounter is over.

Model Turn: During their turn a model will take 3 actions in order: move, run, and boost. A model starts at the position equal to their Initiative.

Move Action: The model moves their Speed forward on track.

Run Action: The model takes a test against the DC given by the encounter level. The model may choose Athletics, Acrobatics, or Endurance with -2 penalty. On success the model moves their Speed forward on the track. On failure, nothing happens.

Power Boost: The model may use one of their powers. The power is exhausted as if it was used in combat. Different powers have different effects as listed next. Keep in mind that a power often has more than one effect.

- Encounter Power: Move a number of positions equal to power's level x 50%.
- Daily Power: Move a number of positions equal to power's level.
- Monster Recharge Power: Move a number of positions equal to power's level x 75%.
- Utility Power: Power can target another party member.
- Power applies a condition to target, single target: Move one enemy back 4 positions.
- Power applies a condition to target, area effect: Move all enemies back 2 positions.
- Power enhances movement: Move forward an extra 4 positions.

Encounter: Trapped Area

Challenge: Encounter Rewards

The MGX enhances the encounter rewards (DMG 41) for greater realism and balance. Magic items aren't readily available as in the core rules. Instead the characters must use their skills to loot the remnants of an encounter. The gold value of a monster is available in the Level Lookup Table. These values were calculated by taking the average values from the core rules. The treasure found in n encounter can then be used to purchase magic items in town.

Core Rewards

Scene: Although an encounter and a short rest take less than 10 minutes, in the MGX it takes 1 time block. This includes the time it takes for the groups to approach each other, the battle itself, rest, and carefully looting the remnants.

XP Reward: The party gets an XP reward equal to the XP value of the encounter (DMG 120). The reward is equally divided among all characters.

- Win: The party earns 100% of the XP award.
- Lose: The party earns 50% of the XP award.

Money Reward: The money reward is explained in the next section "Treasure".

Milestone: The encounter counts for the purposes of a milestone (PHB 259, DMG 123). This is true whether the party won or not.

TREASURE

Models: The first step is for the players to identify the type and level of the enemies available for looting. This is easily done by the DM sharing the encounter roster with them.

- A standard monster can be looted once. Four minion monsters count as 1 standard monster. An elite monster counts as 2 standard monsters and grants a loot skill +2 bonus. A solo monster counts as 5 standard monsters and grants a loot skill +5 bonus.
- A trap can be looted once.

Loot Challenge: To loot a monster, roll a skill challenge with the following rules.

- Each monster must be individually looted. Any character can loot any number of monsters.
- The skill used is based on the monster's parameters as shown on the next table. The table priority goes from top to bottom. A monster can be looted as a lower priority, but with a loot skill -2 penalty.
- The base value of the loot packet is the gold value of the monster's level, aka M-Gold on the "Level Lookup Table". The packet type (PHB 300) must be chosen among the options available. The packet can be sold at the common merchant.

Skill Challenge: Loot Monster

Skills:	Based on monster
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	1 success before 1 failure
DC:	By monster level

Results	Effects
0 S, 1 F	Loot packet worth M-Gold x 50%
1 S, 0 F	Loot packet worth M-Gold x 100%

Loot Skill Priority Table

Monster Parameters	Skill	Option 1	Option 2
Humanoid with equipment	Thievery	Gold	Gold
Construct, Trap	History (Engineering)	Reagent	Residuum
Undead	Religion	Incense	Residuum
Natural	Nature	Salves	Herbs
Fey, Shadow	Arcana, Nature	Herbs	Salves
Elemental	Arcana	Reagent	Residuum
Immortal	Religion	Incense	Herbs
Aberrant	Dungeoneering	Salves	Reagent